

First Customer Deal Overview

Bryan McInerney / Intelligent Annuity Solutions, LLC

1. Who Is Bryan McInerney?

Bryan "Mac" McInerney is the founder of Intelligent Annuity Solutions, LLC, based in Hudson, Ohio. He is a financial advisor who offers securities through LPL Financial (the largest independent broker-dealer in the U.S., regulated by FINRA and the SEC). His business website is www.checkannuity.com.

Bryan specializes in annuity and insurance-based financial strategies. He helps clients manage taxes, reduce fees, and optimize portfolio returns while reducing risk. He met Sam for coffee on May 15, 2026, was enthusiastic about what Simpl ABI does, and explicitly asked to engage us to assist his prospecting efforts.

Contact Information

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2. What Bryan Does (His Business)

Bryan sells annuity and insurance products to help clients in three main ways:

- Manage taxes using insurance-based strategies
- Eliminate unnecessary fees that traditional wealth managers charge
- Increase overall portfolio returns while reducing risk exposure

His pitch to prospects: "You probably already have a wealth manager, but are you really getting the value for the fees you're paying? I can use insurance solutions to do better."

3. Bryan's Ideal Client Profiles

1. High Net Worth Business Owners

Tax-sensitive and fee-conscious. Already have a wealth manager but may not be getting adequate value. Bryan positions insurance solutions as a better alternative for tax management and fee elimination.

2. Near-Retirees Needing Growth Without Risk

People in or approaching retirement who need to stay invested for growth but absolutely cannot afford a market loss. Annuities provide downside protection.

3. Retirees Needing More Income

People in or near retirement who need additional income streams. Annuity products can provide guaranteed income.

4. People with Existing Annuities

Prospects who already own annuities but could benefit from refinancing into better, more fee-sensitive contracts. This is a comparison/upgrade play.

4. Target Industries

Bryan identified 7 specific industries to target. The common thread: all are business-owner-heavy industries where the owners tend to be high net worth, tax-sensitive, and likely already have advisors who may be underperforming.

- Doctors / Medical Practices
- Dentists / Dental Practices
- Lawyers / Law Firms
- Car Dealerships
- Powersports Dealers
- Apparel and Promotional Companies
- Trucking Companies

5. What Bryan Needs From Simpl ABI

Bryan's core need is simple: he wants his customer outreach and marketing handled for him so he can focus entirely on closing sales. He does not want to prospect. He wants warm leads delivered to him.

Specifically, he needs:

- Automated prospecting targeting his 7 industries in his geographic area
- Outreach messaging tailored to his 4 ideal client profiles
- A pipeline that identifies, contacts, and warms up prospects without his involvement
- All content to be compliant with LPL Financial's strict marketing rules (see Section 6)

THE VISION: Bryan wakes up, checks his calendar, and sees meetings with pre-qualified prospects who already understand what he does and want to talk. Simpl ABI handles everything before that meeting.

6. The LPL Compliance Constraint

This is the single most important factor in how we design our service for Bryan.

What is LPL Financial?

LPL Financial is the broker-dealer Bryan is registered through. It is the largest independent broker-dealer in the U.S. Because Bryan offers securities through LPL, all of his public-facing communications are regulated by FINRA (Financial Industry Regulatory Authority) and the SEC. LPL enforces these rules on Bryan's behalf.

The Rule

Bryan's exact words: "I cannot send emails, correspondence, post on social, or put myself out to the public without first obtaining approval from LPL."

This means every piece of marketing or outreach that goes out with Bryan's name on it must be reviewed and approved by LPL's compliance team BEFORE it is sent. This creates a speed bottleneck that directly affects how Simpl ABI delivers value.

What This Means for Us

If every individual email or social post needs LPL approval before sending, our automation cannot run freely. We would generate content and then wait in a queue. This kills the core value proposition of zero-effort marketing.

7. The Critical Question We Must Answer

Before we can design our service for Bryan, we need to understand exactly how LPL's approval process works in practice. There may be paths that let us move fast without hitting the compliance bottleneck every time.

Possible paths around the bottleneck:

1. Pre-Approved Templates

Can Bryan get a batch of outreach templates approved by LPL once, and then reuse them freely? If yes, we build a library of 20-30 compliant templates, get them approved in one shot, and our automation fills in personalization details and sends at will. This is the ideal scenario.

2. Correspondence vs. Retail Communications

FINRA distinguishes between "correspondence" (1-to-1 or small group messages) and "retail communications" (25+ people in 30 days). Correspondence often has lighter review requirements -- sometimes only supervisory review after the fact, not pre-approval. If Bryan's outreach is personalized 1-to-1, the rules may be significantly looser.

3. Non-Securities Content

If outreach does NOT mention specific investment products, returns, or strategies -- for example, a simple introduction email saying "I help business owners in your industry plan for their financial future, would you like to meet?" -- does that even trigger compliance review? There may be a lane for general relationship-building that avoids securities marketing rules entirely.

4. Insurance-Only Content

Bryan uses "insurance solutions" as a core part of his offering. Insurance products (unless they are variable annuities) are often NOT securities and fall under state insurance regulations, not FINRA. If some outreach focuses purely on insurance, LPL's approval process may not apply at all.

KEY QUESTION FOR BRYAN: "Can you get outreach templates pre-approved by LPL so that once a template is cleared, you can send it as many times as you want to different prospects? And does 1-to-1 personalized correspondence require the same approval as mass marketing?"

8. Compliance Word Rules (Summary)

Bryan provided a 16-page LPL compliance guide listing dozens of words and phrases that are banned or restricted in marketing materials. We have fully digested this document. Below is a summary of the most critical rules. Every piece of content we generate must be checked against these.

Investment-Related Banned Terms (Examples)

- "Guaranteed / Secure / Safe" -- Use instead: manage risk, preserve, conservative, mitigate
- "Achieve / Realize / Ensure" -- Use instead: pursue, work toward, seek, aim
- "Trusted / Objective / Unbiased" -- Use instead: personalized, collaborative, experienced
- "Unique / Innovative / Cutting-edge" -- Use instead: independent, comprehensive, specialized
- "Peace of mind / Sleep at night" -- Use instead: confidence, meaningful
- "Maximize / Optimize" (as certainty) -- OK when framed as a goal, not a promise
- "Eliminate / Minimize risk" -- Use instead: manage, mitigate, position
- "Best / Superior / Elite / World-class" -- Use instead: well-regarded, dynamic, quality
- "Expert / Guru" -- Use instead: professional, specialist, seasoned, qualified
- "Don't miss out / Act fast / Opportunity of a lifetime" -- Never (false urgency)
- "Always / Never" (market absolutes) -- Use instead: historically, often, rarely

Business-Related Banned Terms (Examples)

- "Financial planning firm" -- Only if the entity is a Registered Investment Advisor (RIA)
- "Affiliated with LPL" -- Only individuals can say this, not DBA entities
- "We don't sell products" -- Registered reps are legally salespeople
- "Fully licensed" -- No such designation exists; list actual licenses instead
- Negative remarks about competitors, other advisors, or prior firms -- Never

Banned Images

- Money trees -- Never allowed in any context
- Gold bars / coins -- Never allowed in any context
- Golden eggs, upward arrows -- Context dependent, generally avoid

OUR COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE: Generic marketing agencies do not know these rules. They would produce content full of banned terms, Bryan would submit it to LPL, it would get rejected, and weeks would be wasted. We bake compliance into content generation from day one. This is a genuine moat.

9. Why This Deal Matters

1. First Customer = Proof of Concept

Bryan is Simpl ABI's first potential paying customer. Successfully delivering for him proves our business model works in the real world.

2. Built-In Referral Channel

Bryan explicitly said he wants to "tell his friends about your business." If we deliver results, he becomes an active evangelist. Financial advisors know other financial advisors -- this could open an entire vertical.

3. Compliance Expertise as a Moat

If we master FINRA/LPL compliance for Bryan, we can replicate this for every financial advisor registered through LPL (or any other broker-dealer). There are roughly 22,000 advisors at LPL alone. The compliance problem is universal in this industry, and almost nobody solves it well.

4. Repeatable Playbook

Bryan's 7 target industries, 4 client profiles, and compliance constraints give us a concrete, specific use case to build around. Once we nail it, we can templatize the entire playbook for the next financial advisor client.

10. Immediate Next Steps

1. Get Clarity on LPL Approval Process

Ask Bryan the critical question: can templates be pre-approved for reuse? What about 1-to-1 correspondence? What about non-securities or insurance-only content? This determines our entire service architecture.

2. Review www.checkannuity.com

Study Bryan's existing website to understand his current positioning, tone, and branding so our outreach content aligns with how he already presents himself.

3. Research the 7 Target Industries

Build prospect lists for Doctors, Dentists, Lawyers, Car Dealers, Powersports, Apparel/Promo, and Trucking companies in Bryan's geographic area (Hudson, OH / greater Cleveland-Akron market).

4. Draft Compliant Outreach Templates

Create initial outreach email and messaging templates that are pre-vetted against the LPL compliance guide. These become the foundation of the automated pipeline.

5. Define Service Scope and Pricing

Based on what we learn from steps 1-4, define exactly what Simpl ABI delivers to Bryan, how it works, and what it costs. Present a formal proposal.

*Prepared for internal discussion between Sam Karman and Jacob.
All information sourced from Bryan McInerney's email dated May 15, 2026.*